

SLM Custom Art

Website Overview & Analysis

A look at where the project stands today — what is working well, and where the best opportunities for improvement lie.
Prepared May 2026.

At a glance

This is a clean, hand-built static website (HTML, CSS, and a little vanilla JavaScript) for a watercolor portrait artist who paints homes and pets. It has a clear brand, sensible page structure, and real content already in place: a gallery, an about/process section, pricing, and a contact form. The foundation is genuinely strong for this stage. The main gaps are the things you would expect at this point — the galleries are hardcoded rather than data-driven, there is no mobile layout yet, and a handful of polish items (accessibility, SEO metadata, a couple of typos) are worth a pass before launch.

Strengths

A cohesive, intentional brand

The visual identity feels considered rather than accidental. The warm cream background (#fcf5eb), sage-green accent (#6b9080), and the font pairing — Great Vibes script for the logo and page titles, Playfair Display for body copy, Fraunces in the hero — read as elegant and appropriate for a fine-art product. The same palette and components carry across every page, which gives the site a finished, professional feel.

Sensible structure and navigation

The information architecture is logical: Gallery, About, and Ordering are grouped into dropdown menus, with Home and Contact as direct links. A first-time visitor can find what they need without thinking. The dropdowns animate smoothly and the nav underline hover effect is a nice touch.

Thoughtful UX details

- The homepage hero uses a randomized, cross-fading slideshow of portraits — an inviting, dynamic first impression.
- Buttons have considered hover states (color shift plus a subtle lift), and the contact form fields have clean focus styling.
- The featured section alternates image/text left-and-right, with warm, well-written marketing copy for both home and pet portraits.

Real, useful content already in place

Many early projects are all chrome and no substance. Here the pricing tables, contact form, process steps, and ordering pages already carry genuine information a customer would want. The CSS is also organized with clear

section comments, which will make it much easier to maintain and hand off.

Opportunities

None of these are signs that something is wrong — they are the natural next steps for a project at this stage. They are ordered roughly by impact.

1. Make the galleries data-driven (covered in the companion guide)

Right now each gallery is a fixed list of `<img>` tags, and the homepage slideshow keeps its own duplicate copy of the image paths in `index.js`. Every time the artist finishes a new piece, the HTML has to be edited by hand. Moving this content into a database (and showing each piece as a titled card) is the single highest-value upgrade, and is the subject of the second PDF you asked for.

2. Add a mobile layout

There are currently no media queries, and several pieces are sized for desktop: the hero is a fixed 600px tall with a 3.5rem headline, the featured rows sit side-by-side with large fixed margins, and the gallery is locked to three columns. On a phone these will overflow or shrink awkwardly. A handful of breakpoints (collapsing the nav into a menu, stacking the featured rows, and letting the gallery reflow to one or two columns) would make a large difference, since most visitors to a site like this arrive on mobile.

3. Accessibility

- Every gallery and featured image has an empty `alt=""` attribute. Descriptive alt text helps screen-reader users and also improves search ranking.
- Form labels are not linked to their inputs. Adding matching `for / id` attributes makes the form usable with assistive technology.
- The dropdown menus open on hover only, so they cannot be reached by keyboard. Supporting focus/click would make the nav fully accessible.

4. SEO and page metadata

Every page shares the same title, “SlmCustomArt,” the description meta tag is commented out, and there are no social-share (Open Graph) tags or favicon. Unique, descriptive titles and descriptions per page — plus a favicon — are quick wins that help the business get found.

5. Wire up the contact form

The form looks great but has no action, so submitting it currently does nothing. A no-backend service such as Formspree or Netlify Forms can deliver submissions straight to the artist’s inbox with minimal setup — important, since this form is the primary way customers place orders.

6. Small polish items

- Visible typos: the gallery titles read “Home Potraits” and “Pet Potraits” (missing the “r”), and the homepage copy says “a irreplaceable” (should be “an”).
- The dropdown parent links use empty `href=""`, which can cause an unwanted page reload when clicked.

- Reduce repetition: the full nav and footer are copy-pasted into every page. As the site grows, a small JavaScript include or a build step keeps them in sync from one source.
 - Image performance: the photos are large JPGs served at full size. Adding `loading="lazy"` and compressing/resizing them will speed up the galleries. Note too that some filenames contain spaces and a © symbol, which is best avoided in web URLs.
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Bottom line

You have built a tasteful, coherent site with a real brand and real content — a strong base to grow from. The next moves are to make the galleries dynamic, add a mobile layout, and tidy up accessibility and metadata before launch. The companion guide walks through the gallery-and-database upgrade step by step.